

Seth Strickland

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Education

Cornell University 2022
Ph.D., Medieval Literature Ithaca, NY
• Dissertation: “Rewrite this Book: Compilation and Experimental Literary Practices in *Piers Plowman* and Late Medieval English Book Culture”
M.A., Medieval Literature 2019
Saint Louis University St. Louis, MO
M.A., English 2016
• Thesis: “Double Vision: *Piers Plowman* and the Medieval Miscellany”
Hillsdale College Hillsdale, MI
B.A., Classics and English Literature 2012

Academic Appointments

Proofs & Reasons May 2026 – Present
Researcher Carnegie Mellon University
• Combines recent advances in natural language processing with CMU’s growing leadership in digital humanities to provide the first window onto the long-timescale development of mathematical imagination and the ways calculational techniques hybridize with a broader spiritual and mystical imaginary.
Carnegie Mellon University Aug 2023 – Present
Lecturer – Writing and Communications Pittsburgh, PA
• **Courses Taught:** 76-106: Poetry for Programmers – novel course design that unites philosophy of computer science and poetics.
76-101: Hunger: Interpretation and Argument; 76-270: Writing for the Professions.
• **Service:** Member, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Working Group.
Cornell University Aug 2022 – May 2023
Joseph F. Martino ’53 Lecturer in Undergraduate Teaching Ithaca, NY
• **Courses Taught:** Erotic Ecologies I & II; Medieval Dreams and Modern Insomnia.
Cornell University Aug 2017 – Dec 2021
Instructor of Record Ithaca, NY
• **Courses Taught:** Writing and Community Engagement; American Voices; Games and Contests (Writing about Place/Motion); Collecting Evidence (Mystery Stories).
• **Teaching Assistant:** Medical Humanities (Spring 2019).
• **Service:** President, Medieval Studies Graduate Organization; Graduate Policy and Liaison Committee Member.

Saint Louis University

Instructor of Record

Aug 2014 – May 2016

St. Louis, MO

- **Courses Taught:** Advanced Strategies in Rhetoric and Research.
- **Co-Founder:** Text Mining Initiative, Walter J. Ong, S.J., Center for Digital Humanities.
- **Service:** EGSO Event Planner and Treasurer; EGSO Committee Member; Graduate Student Association Representative for English.

Digital Humanities & Public Scholarship

Digital Humanities Lab

Co-Founder

2015 – Present

Pittsburgh, PA

- Establishing a working group for researchers in CMU's English department and beyond focused on practical digital and computational solutions to real research problems.

Digital Humanities Research Group

Department Coordinator

2015 – Present

Pittsburgh, PA

- Coordinating speakers for CMU's English department in coordination with the Posner Center and CMU Libraries to give local scholars of DH a platform

Issuing Citations

Chair and Co-Founder

2015 – Present

Pittsburgh, PA

- Established and coordinated a meeting space for graduate students to present WIP to peers from other disciplines.

Glyph Machina

Medievalist & Technical Liaison

2023 – Present

Remote

- Updated an .xml visual editor and wrote software to expand Latin abbreviations automatically.
- Transcribed manuscripts to .xml format and corrected transcriptions in VS Code.
- Authored approved SBIR Pre-application documents and internal technical documentation.

Public Works

Co-Founder

2022 – 2023

Ithaca, NY

- Co-founded and maintained an interdisciplinary lecture series aimed at connecting academic speakers with public audiences (www.publicworks.info).

Text Mining Initiative

Co-Founder

2014 – 2016

St. Louis, MO

- Co-founded a digital humanities working group aimed at genre identification through distant reading practices.

Publications & Creative Work

Academic Publications

"III Middle English: Langland" (May 2025). In: *The Year's Work in English Studies* 104.1.

"Review of Elise Wang, *The Making of Felony Procedure in Middle English Literature*" (2025). In: *Law and History Review*.

- “III Middle English: Langland” (May 2024). In: *The Year’s Work in English Studies* 103.1. URL: <https://academic.oup.com/ywes/advance-article/doi/10.1093/ywes/maae005/7679460?searchresult=1>.
- “III Middle English: Langland” (July 2023). In: *Year’s Work in English Studies* 102.1, pp. 171–263. URL: <https://academic-oup-com.cmu.idm.oclc.org/ywes/article/102/1/171/7220008>.
- “III Middle English: Langland” (July 2022). In: *Year’s Work in English Studies* 101.1, pp. 185–282. URL: <https://academic-oup-com.cmu.idm.oclc.org/ywes/article/101/1/185/6646567>.
- “Review of Arvind Thomas, Piers Plowman and the Reinvention of Church Law in the Late Middle Ages” (2022). In: *Recherche littéraire / Literary Research* 38.1 Automne, pp. 203–208. URL: <https://www.peterlang.com/document/1275890>.

Creative Works

- “[My father didn’t see the possum trundling]” (2024). In: *The Pierian*.
- “[Nothing Can Express it]” (May 2024). In: *Stink Eye Magazine*. URL: <https://stinkeyemagazine.com/seth-strickland/>.
- “Goodbye, Mexico: Poems of Remembrance” (2020). In: ed. by Sarah Cortez. Texas A&M University Press. Chap. A Certain Lie about the Phoenix.
- “Imagination” (2015). In: *The Tower Light*.
- “[When you know what it is to suffer]” (2012). In: *The Tower Light*.
- “Garlic” (2012). In: *The Tower Light*.
- “Orion” (2012). In: *The Tower Light*.

Invited Lectures (Selected)

The Beatrice Institute	Pittsburgh, PA
• “Reflections on Lucian Simon’s ‘Schola’ (1926)”	Aug 2025
• “Romantic Poetry: The Theology of Blake’s Poison Tree”	Mar 2025
• “Piers Plowman and Questions of Justice”	Feb 2025
• “Old English Poetry: Dream of the Rood”	Jan 2025
• “Reflections on Robert Gwathmey’s ‘Hoeing’”	Aug 2024
University of Pittsburgh	Pittsburgh, PA
• “The manuscripts of Piers Plowman”	Sept 2023
International Poetry Forum	Pittsburgh, PA
• “Albertus Magnus as Guidance for Ethics and AI” (Poets-in-Person series)	Nov 2024

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Project & Proposals Award (\$2000)	American Society for Legal History
Provost's Inclusive Teaching Fellowship (\$5000)	Carnegie Mellon University
Centre for Medieval Literature Graduate Student Bursary	SDU / York
Cornell University Conference Research Travel Grant	Cornell University
Sage Fellowship	Cornell University
Alan Young-Bryant Poetry Award	Cornell University
Truman Capote PhD Writer's Award	Cornell University
President's Fund Travel Grant	Cornell University
Vatican Film Library Research Grant (\$8000)	Saint Louis University
Donald Howard Travel Scholarship	New Chaucer Society
Saint Louis University Graduate Assistantship	Saint Louis University
Alan F. Hilfiker Endowed Graduate Scholarship	Saint Louis University
Newberry Renaissance Consortium Grant	Newberry Library
University Writing Services Mentor of the Month	Cornell University

Conference Presentations

Bannon, Dylan et al. (2025). "Making the Law Legible: a self-correcting BERT-like transformer as manuscript transcription aid". The 27th Conference of the Association for the Study of Law, Culture, and the Humanities.

"Divine Daughters in Law" (2025). 27th Conference of the Association for the Study of Law, Culture, and the Humanities at Georgetown Law in Washington, D.C.

"The Brazen Head of Vector Analysis: Robert Grosseteste and Albertus Magnus as Technological Forerunners" (2025). Twentieth International Conference on Interdisciplinary Social Sciences | Minds and Machines: Artificial Intelligence, Algorithms, Ethics, and Order in Global Society.

"The Last Medieval Scribe: John Colyns and Authorial Control" (2023). Public Works. Ithaca, NY.

"Playing Chicken with Fate: Fortunate Dreams of the Body in Chaucer's 'The Nun's Priest's Tale'" (2022). New Chaucer Society. Durham University.

"Your Own Personal Archive: Piers Plowman and Innovations of Abstraction" (2022). Centre for Medieval Literature. The Danish Institute, Rome.

"'Speke, Parrot': Echoes of Romance in Harley 2252" (2019). Leeds International Medieval Congress. University of Leeds.

"Death in Unity: Skepticism, Wounds, and Epistemic Crises in Piers Plowman B.20" (2019). 7th International Piers Plowman Society Meeting. University of Miami.

"Peace at Peace: Scales of Redemption in Piers Plowman" (2018). New Chaucer Society Biennial Congress. University of Toronto.

"Incest and the Grammar of the Gloss: Productive Omission in Pericles and Confessio Amantis." (2016). IV International Congress of the John Gower Society. Apollonius and Pericles: Manuscripts, Rhetoric, Performance, and Desire. Durham University.

“Roundtable: Doing DH: Opportunities and Challenges for Graduate Students in the Digital Humanities.” (2016). With Helen Davies, University of Mississippi; Margaret Smith, Saint Louis University. 4th Annual Symposium on Medieval and Renaissance Studies. Saint Louis University.

“Which Time Is It? Digital Queries and Early Modern Period Schemes.” (2016). Co-written and presented with Jonathan Sawday, Lauren Kersey, and Geoffrey Brewer. The Walter J. Ong Symposium on Digital Humanities. Saint Louis University.

Service & Organization

- **Organizer:** 7th International Piers Plowman Society (Miami, FL); TMI Inaugural Conference (St. Louis).
- **Panel Organizer:** Activism I & II (IPPS); Slaughterhouse Vibes (SLU Symposium).
- **Session Chair:** Futures of Tradition (Cornell); Activism II (IPPS); Chaucerian Narratives (Illinois Medieval Association).

Skills & Languages

Research Languages:

- *Professional/Advanced:* Latin, Middle English, Old English
- *Intermediate/Reading:* French (B1), Old Norse, German
- *Basic:* Spanish, Italian, Old French, Attic Greek

Technical Skills:

- *Languages/Formats:* Python, Julia, HTML5, LaTeX, XML/TEI
- *Tools:* VS Code, Text Mining (Stylometry), Linux